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DJIA 52361.58 ▲ 146.42 0.28% NASDAQ 26169.38 ▲ 0.8% STOXX 600 640.66 ▲ 0.8% 10-YR. TREAS. yield 4.987% OIL $101.76 ▼ $1.51 GOLD $4,022.30 ▲ $31.20 EURO $1.1174 YEN 157.50

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Brazilian President** Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva's surprise re-election routed stocks and other financial assets in the South American country, punishing global investors who had bet on his defeat. **A1, A6**

◆ **The Fed is expected** to hold interest rates steady this week for reasons that have as much to do with what Fed officials have said as with what the economy is doing. **A2**

◆ **Anthropic started** the clock on its initial public offering, revealing a prospectus that offered a mix of promise and peril. **B1**

◆ **U.S. stocks rose after** the Anthropic document became public, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow gaining 0.7%, 0.8% and 0.3%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **DoorDash is in** advanced talks to acquire food delivery rival Instacart in a deal that could be completed as soon as this week. **B1**

◆ **Microsoft extended** voluntary buyout offers to thousands of employees in the U.S. and abroad. **B1**

◆ **JetBlue sought to** calm jittery investors with a message that the airline's turnaround strategy is working and it can ride out turbulence from high fuel prices. **B3**

◆ **Verizon again boosted** its full-year outlook as it continues to attract new customers for its postpaid phone service. **B3**

◆ **Whirlpool said it** expects to post a loss for the year as consumers, nervous about inflation and war abroad, continue to resist buying appliances. **B3**

◆ **FedEx hired** Jamere Jackson as its new chief financial officer, plucking the executive from AutoZone. **B2**

Worldwide

◆ **Few policy differences** separate Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and the leading opposition candidate, Gadi Eisenkot, as Israelis prepared to vote on Tuesday. **A1**

◆ **The Justice Department** is attempting a third prosecution of former FBI director and longtime Trump critic James Comey, this time on allegations that he leaked national-defense information 10 years ago. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge ruled** that Maurene Comey, the daughter of James Comey, was wrongly fired from her job at the U.S. attorney's office in Manhattan. **A3**

◆ **A federal appeals court** rejected a Trump administration request to require California to set aside mail-in ballots it receives from 20,000 people the federal government says may not be U.S. citizens. **A3**

◆ **The French government** announced concessions in high school and higher education, yielding to demands voiced in student protests that have roiled the nation. **A7**

◆ **The Saudi-led** coalition battling Yemen's Houthi rebels said it degraded their ability to hit targets inside the kingdom by destroying tunnels used to store missiles and launchers. **A6**

◆ **Venezuelan opposition** leader María Corina Machado, who returned home on Sunday, wants free and fair elections to end the rule of interim President Delcy Rodríguez. **A6**

◆ **Jordanian authorities** arrested three men in connection with a deadly attack on a Greek Orthodox Church. **A6**

◆ **Died: Walter Koenig**, 90, Chekov in '60s "Star Trek." **A2**

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France's Protests Draw Concessions From Macron



AURELIEN MORISSARD/PRESS POOL

AFTERMATH: French President Emmanuel Macron, right, and Marseille Mayor Benoît Payan walk Monday through City Hall, which was vandalized amid national student protests. The government plans educational improvements in response to the strife. **A7**

Private Equity Risks Hitting Wall of $300 Billion in Debt

Firms scramble to get extensions for loans about to come due in 2028, 2029

By Matt Wirz And Mark Maurer

Private-equity firms are racing to negotiate loan extensions on much of a $300 billion wall of debt coming due from the companies they own, hoping to avoid a potential wave of defaults that threatens to wipe out the firms' investments.

It is a pressing need that is intensifying because rising interest rates have made refinancing more expensive this year. And much of it is for software companies at risk of being eclipsed by artificial-intelligence companies like Anthropic, which launched a giant initial public offering on Monday.

Buyout fund managers that fail to get loan extensions risk having the companies they own taken over by creditors—and their investments wiped out.

"There are going to be businesses that get the keys tossed back to the bank and don't make it," said Hugh MacArthur, chairman of Bain & Co.'s global private-equity practice.

Most companies refinance large obligations 18 to 24 months in advance as a precaution, whittling down the amount of debt coming due in that time frame.

Companies owned by private equity have found that harder to do, creating an unusually high "maturity wall" in coming years.

About $140 billion in risky corporate loans are scheduled to mature in 2028 and another $160 billion in 2029.

By comparison, from 2023 to 2025, there was an average of about $60 billion due in two years, according to data from PitchBook.

Software companies account for about one-third of the loans coming due in 2028 and 2029, in large part because private-equity funds binged on buyouts of the technology companies over the last decade. Private-credit firms that made many of the loans are also under pressure from default risk.

Private-equity firms built the foundations of the debt wall in 2021, when low interest rates during the pandemic fueled a record year for megadeals like the $11.8 bil-

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Surprise Lula Win Crashes Brazilian Markets

Victory shatters investors' hopes for overhauls including cuts, deregulation

Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva's surprise re-election routed stocks and other financial assets in the South American country, punishing global investors who had bet on his defeat.

*By **Fabiana Negrin Ochoa**, **Chelsey Dulaney** and **Heather Gillers***

The Brazilian real slid nearly 8% on Monday, its greatest one-day decline since 1999, according to LSEG data. The country's benchmark stock index fell 14%, the worst one-day drop since the onset of the Covid-19 pandemic. The index's plunge triggered a circuit breaker, leading Brazil's stock-exchange operator to temporarily halt trading.

Global investors had piled into Brazilian markets in recent weeks after Flávio Bolsonaro—the eldest son of former President Jair Bolsonaro—bested da Silva in the first round of the election in early October. Investors cheered Bolsonaro's anticipated election victory, sending the Bovespa stock index to a record high on hopes he would carry out investor-friendly policies such as spending cuts and deregulation.

On Sunday, the leftist leader won 51.8% of the vote against 48.2% for Bolsonaro, electoral authorities said, with over 99% of the votes counted. He was just two days away

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◆ **How Lula pulled off an upset in Brazil** **A6**

Netanyahu, Rival Share Similar Views on Security

By Anat Peled

TEL AVIV—Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel and the leading opposition candidate, Gadi Eisenkot, couldn't be more different in terms of style, background and a host of issues that matter to Israeli voters.

But on the questions that matter most to the rest of the world—the future of Gaza, the war with Iran and a Palestinian state—the substantive differences between the man who has governed Israel on and off for 19 years and his challenger are narrower.

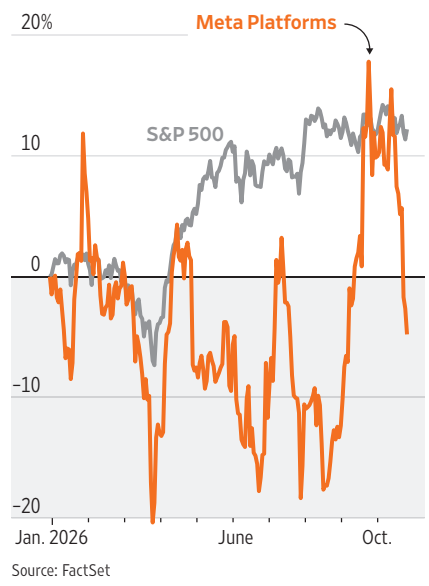
Israelis are slated to vote on Tuesday in the first national election since the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks. Polls show that while they are worried about growing settler extremism and threats to the country's institutions, the public is practically united on many security-related questions, reflecting a lurch to the right on national-security matters since the attacks that sparked the war in Gaza.

That consensus is shrinking the room to maneuver for the 66-year-old Eisenkot, who formed his centrist party last year and is now Netanyahu's main challenger.

Analysts said the lifelong military man whose youngest son died fighting in Gaza understands the limits and costs of military force. Still, he pushes tough positions. He has

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Share-price and index performance, year to date



Source: FactSet

Meta Set To Sell $95 Billion In Stock

Meta plans to raise up to $95 billion from new stock offerings as it embarks on a wave of sales to fund its AI infrastructure investments. Nvidia, Advanced Micro Devices and Broadcom have indicated interest in purchasing up to $5 billion worth of common stock. **B1**

For Stars of Steamy Audiobooks, The Job Is Full of Hazards

* * *

Voices of blockbuster 'romantasy' franchise coo and groan under the glare of rabid fans

By Ellen Gamerman

One of today's hottest literary heartthrobs has wings and comes from the Bronx.

Actor Anthony Palmini plays Rhysand, the smoldering character from the hit literary series "A Court of Thorns and Roses," in a full-cast audiobook version of the fantastical tale of romance and adventure. Listeners fall for his roughed-up delivery—like a Yankee fan in a faerie realm—as they devour the steamy novels by Sarah J. Maas.



Tough crowd

"I can say this as fact," said Palmini, "there's a lot of married women who really love these books."

The fictional characters of the Maasverse return this week with "A Court of Splintered Harmony," the sixth book in the blockbuster series that has unspooled labyrinthine tales of pointy-eared faeries and bloodthirsty monsters since 2015. Fans have been waiting five years for the latest installment, which will arrive with live events, brand collaborations and pop-culture chatter.

For a passionate subset, the most anticipated moment comes when they're downloading the full-cast audiobook, a fast-growing style

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How Billionaire Tax Became 'Hot Mess'

California proposal sparks Democratic discord, strange bedfellows on both sides

By Laura J. Nelson And Paul Kiernan

The idea seemed simple at first: a one-time tax on California's billionaires to counter looming cuts to Medicaid.

Instead, the proposed wealth tax has exposed deep divisions among Democrats and created strange bedfellows on both sides working to defeat or pass the proposal.

Drama surrounding the measure includes a fight among labor unions worried their own priorities will suffer, tech elites putting down hundreds of millions to defeat it and allegations of extortion and harassment by the tax's architect.

The messy fight has gripped California for the past year and shows how enacting a long-heralded concept on the left—taxing billionaires' stratospheric wealth—is far from easy, even in one of the nation's bluest states. It has been one of the costliest ballot fights in California's history.

Voters will decide on Nov. 3 whether to approve the nation's first-ever wealth tax targeting billionaires. The latest independent polls show

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INSIDE



AP PHOTO/MARIA LYSAKER

SPORTS
The third-string castoff quarterback sparking a Giants turnaround. **A12**



AP PHOTO/MARKUS SCHREIBER

BUSINESS & FINANCE
The biggest takeaways from Anthropic's IPO prospectus mix peril with hope. **B1**